NUTS & BOLTS

Promoting Men's Health and wellbeing through our activities and Social Engagement

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In This Edition

Message from the Editor

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It's always a little difficult to know what's going to be in the first edition of Nuts & Bolts for the year as the agenda for the shed activities for the year is still being figured out.

But then my inbox starts to fill with contributions so thanks to Bob Ikin, Darryl Timms and the ever-reliable Freddie Butler for another good read.

"The plans for mezzanine floor, are still up in the air"

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Carina Men's Shed valued supporters include:

Some Highlights of Shed Year 2025 - The bus trips to the Maritime Museum, Montville and Christmas in July, the Bulimba Golf Day and RSL Bulima Bowls Club awards, Mother's Day Morning Tea, the Veterans Workshops, prize winning shed entries in the Ekka, the AGM and the Kite festival and another successful Family and Friends Day.

Carina Men's Shed valued supporters include:


510
SECOND PRIZE
ROYAL QUEENSLAND SHOW
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668
SECOND PRIZE
ROYAL QUEENSLAND SHOW
SECOND


ARINA MEN'S SHED

Christmas Party ***Friday 12 December 2025***

Our shed's 2025 Christmas party held at the Wade Core room at Carina Leagues Club had a record attendance of 120 members and their partners and the service provided by the League's Club staff and the organization of the speeches, presentations and raffles ensured a great function that was enjoyed by all.

Carina Men's Shed Health and Wellbeing Committee

The committee strives to improve the Health and Wellbeing of all members

Contact details for the committee

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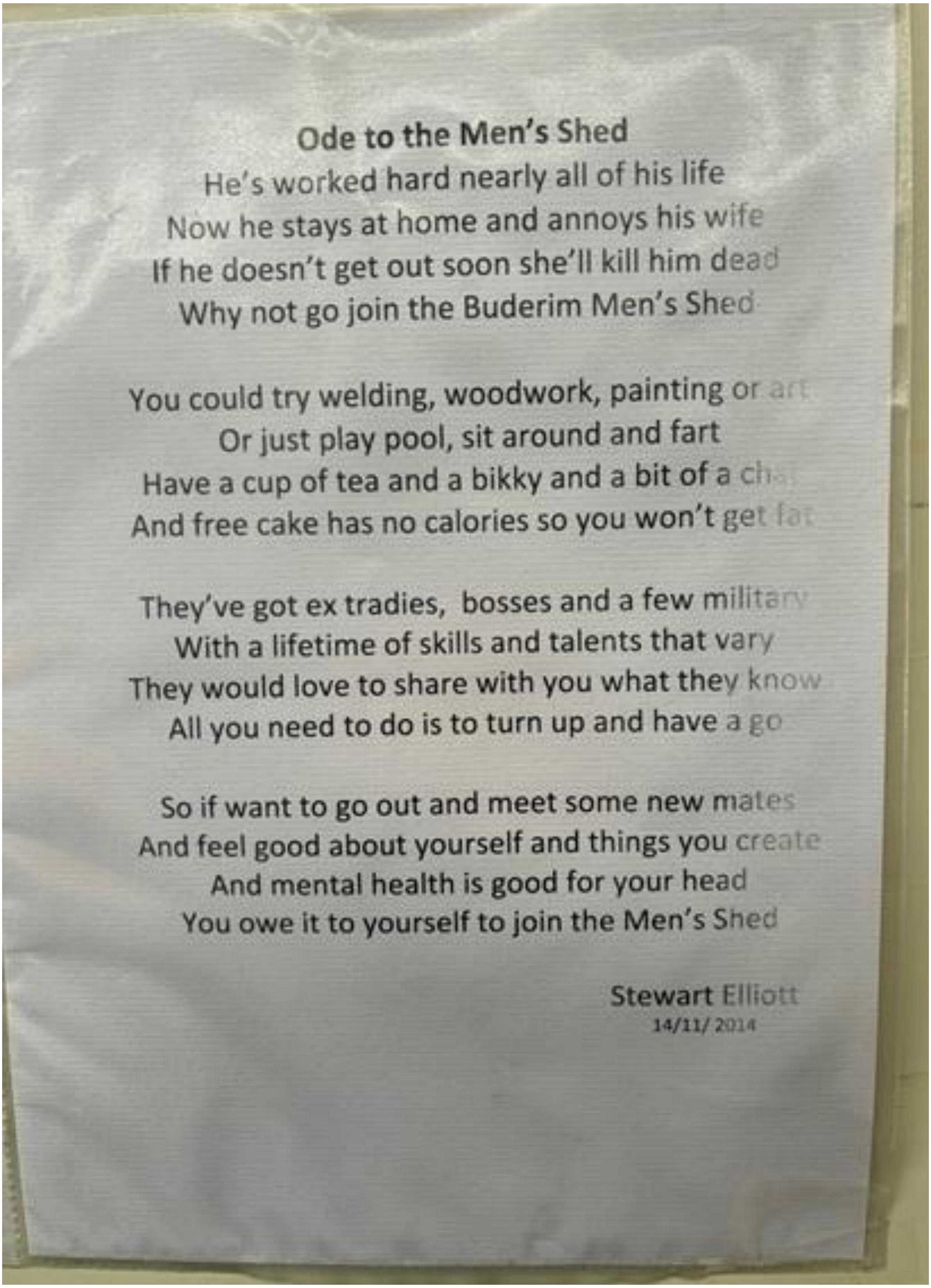
Please feel free to contact any member of the committee to discuss any issues.

Poetry Corner

This poem from Budurim Men's Shed from Phil Allen.



Ode to the Men's Shed

He's worked hard nearly all of his life
Now he stays at home and annoys his wife
If he doesn't get out soon she'll kill him dead
Why not go join the Buderim Men's Shed

You could try welding, woodwork, painting or art
Or just play pool, sit around and fart
Have a cup of tea and a bikky and a bit of a chat
And free cake has no calories so you won't get fat

They've got ex tradies, bosses and a few military
With a lifetime of skills and talents that vary
They would love to share with you what they know
All you need to do is to turn up and have a go

So if want to go out and meet some new mates
And feel good about yourself and things you create
And mental health is good for your head
You owe it to yourself to join the Men's Shed

Stewart Elliott
14/11/2014

December - January Photo Theme – "The Day After"

Andrew Clarkson – Mackay Cyclone Jan-1918 Photo from the Clarkson's family album. A category 4 cyclone with a storm surge of 3.6m and waves of 2-3m reported in the main street and major flooding in all the major rivers from Townsville to Rockhampton.

Gordon Bowler *- Gordon was on a train trip during the floods. He had to bus it around some damage lines and took this great photo out of the bus window showing the day after the flood destruction.*

Buderim Men's Shed Visit *Thursday 05 February 2026*

The bus arrived at Buderim Shed at 9.45 and as the steep driveway was problematic for 4 members, Jim the president, went and picked them up in his 4WD. Had morning tea, then sat in on a 40 min presentation on their shed history and the things they do. We only had an hour then to see all the areas they work in, including the 4 main ones, plus computer training (CAD) French polishing, gym and small engine repairs. Their setup is very impressive, and we really were impressed and appreciative. Left there to go to the Mooloolaba Surf Club for a delicious lunch at 12pm. From order to service was very quick and as we were finished early, left MSC at 1.45 and arrived back at shed just after 3pm al lovely day had by all. ***Phil Allen***

HMB ENDEAVOUR, THE REPLICA AND THE MODEL *Written by Bob Ikin*

In 2012 I had the good fortune of crewing on the Endeavour replica from Hobart to Melbourne.

Original Ship

In March 1768, the Royal Navy Board purchased the Earl of Pembroke from Thos. Millner for £2,800. The ship was on the Royal Navy list as a Bark and renamed Endeavour. The word "bark" alluded to the build of the hull. Tree nails, oaken dowels 1" to 1½" thick and up to 3"6" long, were driven in as bolts. They were considered superior to iron because they remained swollen tight and did not induce "iron sickness" rust rot into the timber. Endeavour carried 10x4 pounder guns (carriage guns) and 12 swivels or blunderbusses. Endeavour was built of oak, Baltic pine for the decks, topsides, masts, and spars. Oak is very susceptible to rot and marine borers, particularly in the tropics.

The Replica

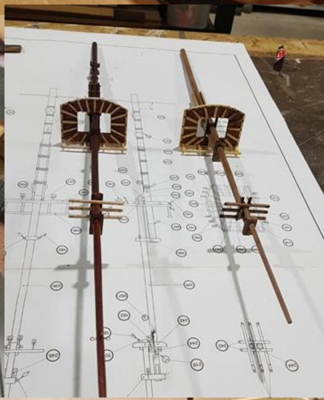
None of the original wood was available in the quantities required so local wood was used. West Australian hardwood jarrah replaced the oak, Douglas fir and Oregon replaced the Baltic pine. Other wood used included Karri, Wandoo, Blackbutt tallow wood, and She Oak was used for the blocks. All the planking was done in the traditional way, using thousands of trunnels (wooden nails). The traditional skills of blacksmith and wood carver were used extensively throughout the ship. Modern paints and varnishes were used to protect the hull and were matched to the original 18th century colors. Below the waterline and at the ends of the planks coach bolts were used instead of iron spikes for added security. As each piece of timber was shaped it was treated first with an epoxy-based preservative and finally red lead. Some people argued it had to be built with the same materials/tools with no additions but although a noble position to take, this would have created tremendous financial, maintenance and safety problems for the future. A compromise was found:

- The ship would be exhaustively researched for historical accuracy.
- Materials would be chosen for the greatest longevity, but original construction methods would not be compromised.
- Modern tools would be used.
- A minimum of modern equipment would be installed to ensure safe navigation and health of the crew.

The Model

Returning from my voyage I decided I would like to make a model of the original Endeavour. Unbelievably, sourcing a model kit proved to be difficult in Brisbane but I eventually found a kit at a hobby shop on Creek Road, Carindale. The proprietor asked me if I had ever made a model of this size and complexity before to which I replied "no". I soon understood why he had a bemused look on his face when he said, "don't attempt to do any of this model unless you are in the right frame of mind." It was not long before I realized I was out of my depth and so I sought the assistance of Bevan Guttormsen who is a boat builder by trade and an experienced model boat builder. Given the space required and the availability of us both we could only work on the model on Saturdays and it has taken five years to complete the model. Bevan has said this project is right up there in terms of complexity in his experience. The reality is the model would not have been completed without Bevan's expertise.

What can be achieved with five years of cooperation and dedication to the task.



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METRES, KILOGRAMS and LITRES

Where did your metric ruler come from?

Research by Darryl Timms
Sourced from the book "Exactly" by Simon Winchester, Internet and YouTube.

Length and time were linked when Galileo in 1582 noticed that a pendulum's rate of swing depended on the length of the pendulum not the weight of the bob. In 1668 John Wilkins an English cleric published a paper based on Galileo's discovery. His proposal was to make a pendulum with a beat of exactly one second. The length of the pendulum, whatever it turned out to be, would be a new unit of length. A unit of volume would be created by using that unit of length. A unit of mass would be created by filling that volume with water. All three standard units would be divided or multiplied by ten. An attempt to revive Wilkins proposal in 1791 by a French statesman, Charles Talleyrand, was unsuccessful. Pendulums vary with latitude.

The French decided that a standard length should be linked to a natural aspect of the earth. It was agreed, the circumference of the earth will be divided by forty million and the answer will become France's new standard measure of length, the Meter, or Metre. To measure the circumference, they chose a meridian that passed through Paris. Only one tenth of the meridian's quadrant from the equator to the north pole was measured; from Dunkirk to Barcelona. A difficult task that took six years. The total length of the quadrant was calculated from the survey findings. The quadrant's length was divided by 10 million and henceforth the answer became the new standard length of 1 meter for post-revolutionary France. A platinum bar was cast, 25mm by 4mm, and 1 meter long exactly, "The Meter of the Archives." It was presented to the French National Assembly on the 22nd of April 1799. The French went further. A cubic decimetre of pure distilled water became the new measure of volume: 1 Litre. The weight of the 1 cubic decimetre of pure distilled water became the new measure of mass: 1 kilogram. A platinum cylinder was cast and adjusted until it exactly balanced the weight of the 1 cubic decimetre of distilled water, "The Kilogram of the Archives." The result: New standard measures for length, weight and volume that were linked.

The meridian was resurveyed several years later. The Meter of the Archives was two tenths of a millimetre shorter than the new measurement. An error that was ignored for many decades. As the nineteenth century progressed the need for an international agreement on standard measurements and the value of using the metric system became self-evident. In 1872 fifty delegates from all the great western powers met in Paris to become the International Metric Commission. In 1875 they reached an agreement that led to the Treaty of the Meter and the formation of the International Bureau of Weights and Measures based in France. Being exact had become an obsession. The I metre length was adjusted to comply with the resurvey and several new (near perfect) I metre bars and I kilogram cylinders were cast, machined, milled, measured, and polished. The best became international prototypes to be kept safe in France. The others were distributed to member nations in 1889.

In 1870, well before 1899, a forward-thinking Scottish physicist James Maxwell challenged the current standards of measurement with his suggestion that true constants in nature were to be found on a fundamental atomic level. The only absolute permanent standards of length, time and mass must be in the wavelength, the period of vibration. It took many decades to convince the world before it was agreed in 1927 that this was the best approach. Krypton was selected in 1960 as the ideal candidate. Henceforth the metre would be defined as the length equal to 1,650,763.73 wavelengths in vacuum of the radiation corresponding to the transmission between prescribed levels of the krypton-86 atom.

In 1983 the metre was linked to time. A metre is now defined as the length of light travelling in a vacuum for a time interval of 1/299.792,458 of a second. From 2019 onwards the kilogram has been redefined in terms of the speed of light and its connection to Planck's Constant. Both length and mass are currently defined in terms of time.

(The circumference of the earth around the poles is 40,008 km, around the equator it is 40,075km.)

"Paper Based Society" – submitted by Freddie Butler

Despite all the publicity about how we are going digital for just about everything, we are often confronted by the fact that we are still a paper-based Society. Most of us get annoyed when paper in the form of advertising (we didn't ask for) gets stuffed into our letterboxes, and how very annoyed we are at home when we can't find a letter or an official document. Even in this day and age, most of us have some kind of paper-based filing system. Ask yourself, where is your land title, or your passport, or even your marriage certificate? Don't even think about the frustration of trying to find your birth certificate!

We can trace ownership of this annoyance back to early civilizations (any nationality will do) who were painting on rock walls and carving stone tablets.

Their act was followed by papyrus writing (Egyptians, Greeks and Romans) followed by pen and ink scribbling on animal skins, by various emerging nations. Then inevitably, came filling in schoolbooks where us good boys (?) got a Gold Star for writing clear cursive script, then a little later came mechanical and electrical printing by many devices.

Present day communication still requires paper, reams and volumes and tons of it, so clearly there remains a demand for paper. Ever wondered how much paper is consumed for computer printouts, used by shops/stores/supermarkets? In fact, paper manufacture is big business worldwide. Very large ships travel the globe delivering phenomenal amounts of woodchip and paper pulp, from forested nations to various other countries, feeding the insatiable paper needs of the modern world. There is obviously a great deal of profitable trading being done.

Since in our capitalist society where there is a profit to be made, somebody somewhere will cut down trees and save the sawdust. Somebody else will get the lumberjacks working at making planks, posts and plywood sheets. These people are secure in the knowledge that eventually timber waste can be pulped, pumped and shipped around the world for welcome profit.

A quick look at some statistics shows that affluent countries export pulp. Some countries import the pulp and value add to the pulp by various processes. Then they profitably export quality paper, cardboard and packaging, to the countries that made the pulp. (How strange is that?) Once the paper is in the hands of the wholesale paper merchants, advertising and marketing companies grow bigger so bigger profit ensues. Paper usage worldwide for 2020 exceeded some 244 million metric tonnes. Pulp is the initial product: -the basis for cardboard boxes of all shapes and sizes, wrapping paper for all occasions, magazines and newspapers and the irritating advertising material that gets into your letterbox.

However, it is interesting to note that all paper is not just 'paper'. Newsprint requires that the paper is thin but strong, and the ink must not 'bleed' from one side of a sheet to the other. Glossy magazine paper must be able to hold bright colours that also must not bleed from one side to the other, and magazine covers must be of a strength to resist rough handling during distribution to the consumer. And, paper that is used for computer 'print out' must not create dust or fluff to cause problems with electronic print heads but must also have sufficient strength and density to allow clear print images.

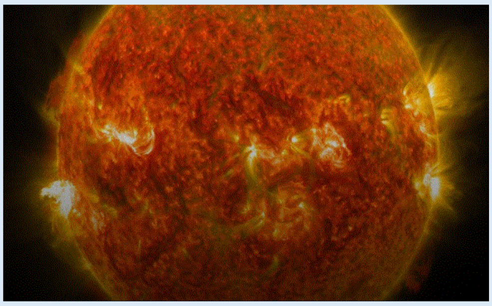
So Paper isn't just 'paper'.

Just to prove the point that specialisation and profiteering abound, have you recently checked how thin the tissues are in the box? Have you noticed that toilet tissue per sheet is now nearly transparent? And as a final thought, have you made some effort towards helping your local recycling paper system? You might even make some dollars for your favourite person.

BUT, probably not in Australia, because our folding money is ***now made of a plastic material!***

Great Moments in Science

Carrington Event



Dr Karl: Today, we humans are a very long way from our pre-electronic ancestors. We are attached to the electronic toys that we enjoy and use: the GPS unit that finds a street in an unfamiliar city, the smart phone that is a camera as well as a dictionary as well as giving access to the internet, and even the accurate watch you wear on your wrist. But what if they were all to suddenly die?

Welcome to the superstorm, when the Sun decides to have a hissy fit! Welcome to the Carrington Event! About one-and-a-half centuries ago, an independently wealthy English astronomer, Richard C. Carrington, was following his normal daily habit of observing the Sun. He had already discovered that the Sun rotated faster at the equator than at the poles.
On August 26, 1859, the Sun had thrown a few billion tonnes of super-hot gas directly at the Earth. The impact with the Earth's magnetic field and the upper atmosphere was so huge, that over the next few days people saw auroras, not just near the poles, but as close as 25° to the equator. In addition, there were major hiccups in the Earth's magnetic field and huge amounts of noise in the telegraph system, so much noise that it took 14 hours to send a mere 400 words. However, as is the nature of such things, it all began to wind down.

But, on 01 September 1859, Richard Carrington saw enormous sunspots on the Sun, so huge that they were easily visible without a telescope. Suddenly, at 11:18am, they flared into an unexpected and white-hot fury. He didn't know it, but another super-hurricane of super-hot -- and super-fast -- gas had just been thrown at the Earth. About 17 hours later, travelling at 2380 kilometres per second, it hit. Nobody had ever described auroras like these. They were so bright that people awoke at 1:00am thinking that the dawn was coming. The auroras threw shadows, and you could read tiny print by their light. They got to within 18° of the Equator, being easily visible in Hawai'i and Panama.

Charged particles almost instantly destroyed five per cent of the ozone in the atmosphere, and the ozone took four years to recover. The magnetic storm set off huge currents in the ground, which invaded the long telegraph lines. Telegraph operators were nearly electrocuted dead by the long, violent sparks erupting from the handsets. And several telegraph stations burnt down.

If the Carrington Event happened today, nearly 10 per cent of the 1000-or-so working satellites in orbit would stop working. That's an immediate $100 billion cost right there. Banks rely on the super-accurate time signals from the GPS satellites, so then you couldn't get your money. Now the electrical grids around the world are mostly old, fragile and overloaded. In the USA alone, minor solar storms already cause breakdowns to the grid that increase the cost of electricity by $500 million every 18 months. But a Carrington Event, when the Sun had a major hissy fit, would kill the entire electrical grid of North America. Any astronauts in orbit would not die from radiation poisoning, but they would get a 70-year lifetime radiation dose in just a few hours. And computers and similar sensitive electronic equipment all over the planet would die from electrical spikes inside their delicate low-voltage circuits.

Something as huge as the Carrington Event is expected every 500 years or so. Recent solar storms have killed satellites in space and power transformers in North America. The solar storm of Bastille Day in 2000 AD, expanded the Earth's atmosphere so much that the International Space Station, instead of losing 40-90 metres of altitude each day, suddenly lost 15,000 metres.

What can we do? The first thing is to know what's happening. In the USA, the Space Weather Prediction Center gives daily space weather reports. But its budget is about 1/1000th of one per cent of the revenues generated by the industries it supports. At the moment, we have one single satellite, the Advance Composition Explorer, giving us 10-20 minutes' warning of a Solar hissy fit. It floats at just one per cent of the distance between us and the Sun. But it's 15 years old (incredibly ancient for a satellite) and it's also the only one of its kind.

Any future satellites that we send up may need to slip, slop and slap.

Puzzles, Jokes & Trivia

"Okay then, what wine do you have if we go up to the four dollar range?"

"Did the box actually say 'candles,' or did you just grab something in the garage that looked like a candle?"

"No, we haven't started yet. My hand was cold."

Can you complete these four words using the same three letter sequence in each?

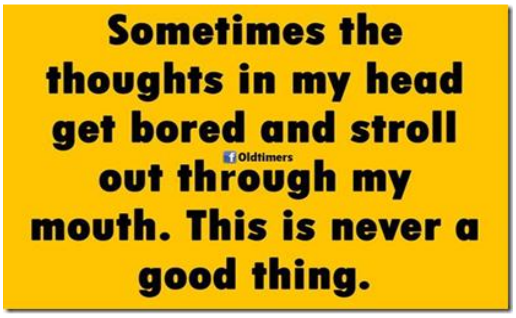
V -- -- -- U E
B -- -- -- H
S Q U -- -- --
F L -- -- --

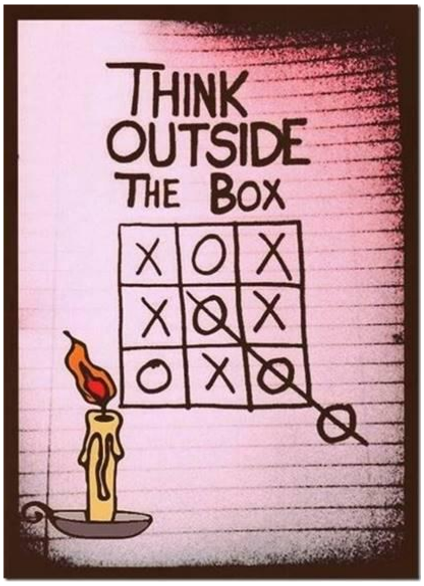
Trivia Quiz

1. How many kangaroos are there on a standard $1 coin?
2. Which colony separated itself from NSW in 1841?
3. In what year was the GST introduced in Australia?
4. Which Australian banknote has featured both Banjo Paterson & Henry Lawson?
5. The Great Victorian Desert lies within which two Australian States?
6. The Bee Gees were named after which member of the band?

Quiz & puzzle solutions next page

Puzzles, Jokes & Trivia





Two exceptional models sighted at our shed on Australia day.

Trivia Quiz Answers

1. Five.
2. New Zealand.
3. 2000.
4. $10 note (Henry Lawson 1966-2017, Banjo Paterson (2017 -).
5. WA & SA.
6. Barry Gibb.

Missing Letters

VIRTUE
BIRTH
SQUIRT
FLIRT